

Cancer Research Needs People from All Backgrounds



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Examples of diversity needed in cancer research

To make sure everyone benefits from cancer research, all types of people with different lived experiences and living conditions need to participate. Some examples of differences include:

- age
- race
- ethnicity
- sex
- sexual orientation
- where people live
- education
- income
- health insurance status
- ability to find, understand, and use health information
- trust in medicine or doctors

Any of these can influence whether someone gets cancer, how they respond to treatment, or their quality of life.

How diversity improves cancer research

Diversity in research participants helps improve understanding of cancer and how it grows and spreads in people from different backgrounds. We can also learn how safe new treatments are for all types of bodies.

Having participants from different communities can help researchers understand barriers that patients face, which could improve how studies

are designed. Detection and diagnosis could improve across populations, and data from studies with diverse participants could help doctors recommend the best treatments for each person.

Everyone can take part

NCI and many other institutions are making cancer research more inclusive by:

- making it easier for all people to participate in studies
- working with community and advocacy organizations to reach underrepresented groups
- improving diversity in the cancer research workforce
- designing cancer clinical trials and research studies that encourage equal access and diversity

Ways to participate in cancer research